The Dhāraṇī for Retaining the Noble Avataṃsaka

Toh 940 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཕལ་པ་ཆེ་གཟུང་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī for Retaining the Noble Avataṃsaka is a very brief incantation that offers a shortcut to the merit of one of the largest scriptures in the Mahāyāna tradition, the Avataṃsaka Sūtra, known in Tibetan as Phal po che. After a homage to the Three Jewels, the text gives a short mantra, opening with namaḥ sarva buddhānām and continuing with seed syllables such as oṃ and bhūṃ. It then declares that whoever retains this formula will in effect retain the noble Avataṃsaka itself, and that writing it out or reading it aloud brings the same result. The work is Toh 940 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the class of short ritual formulas valued for preserving and invoking the power of the Buddha's teachings.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

oṃ nthāṃ namaḥsarba bud ṅhā nāṃ oṃ māṃ bhūṃ mūṃ tadya thā oṃ bhūṃ

By retaining this, one will come to retain the noble Avataṃsaka. Writing it and reading it likewise have the same effect.

The Dhāraṇī for Retaining the Noble Avataṃsaka is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "Avataṃsaka" renders □□□□□□□□, the standard Tibetan name for the Buddhāvataṃsaka Sūtra, the Flower Ornament Scripture. The point of the dhāraṇī is that holding this short formula in memory carries the merit of holding that vast scripture. Writing out the dhāraṇī or reading it aloud is said to have the same effect.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.